

First 4G phone

HTC EVO 4G, America's first ever 4G phone awaited to be launched on June 4, 2010

Crack the code

There is a prominently outdated software in the Audio section of one of the DVDs. Subtract 90 from the version number after the decimal point. Add one to it, and flip to that page number

with operating there anymore, and on the other hand you have so much social context built up that you don't want to just abandon.

It is clear that a new system is needed, and Diaspora might be the answer. This new project aims to make the social web decentralized, giving control of information to the user instead of vesting it with a central authority.

While the project is currently in its funding stages, and is only expected to be released in September this year, it is a brilliant concept indeed. Diaspora is a web application that one would be able to install on their own server, and would allow the same kind of connectivity that one gets from Facebook.

Diaspora servers, called "seeds" — Diaspora means the

will be open source under the a GPL, the team behind Diaspora plans to provide Diaspora hosting much like the WordPress hosting service for the open source blogging platform.

The project which was aiming for a humble \$10,000 in order to fund its progress has by now reached over 10 times its goal at near \$180,000 last we checked. Clearly people are enthusiastic about the implications of controlling their own data.

Canonical Ubuntu 10.04 and beyond

Ubuntu's latest distribution has been released, and for the first time perhaps there is more discussion over the theme of the OS than the features themselves. Many distros based on Ubuntu are accusing it of being a bad parent, by neglecting long

Ubuntu. He shared some of his thoughts about the latest release. We questioned him about some of the details of the new changes in 10.04 and Canonical's role in India.

Ubuntu must be given credit here, for sticking to its mission of being a simple and easy Linux version for everyone and Ubuntu 10.04 is no less. This new version released on 29th April 2010 and brought with it for the first time, a refreshing new look and feel. Not only Ubuntu, but Canonical itself has changed its paradigm. Even so, Ubuntu's first focus is on the user, and making things as simple for them as possible. While the change in theme was mostly welcome, some people were not so appreciative of the most jarring change in the new theme: the relocation of the window minimize, maximize and close buttons to the left of the window instead of the right, making it similar to the Mac rather than Windows.

Of course, we asked Mr Advani about the new theme, and why Canonical was trying to emulate the Mac while trying to entice users from Windows, and why such a change was introduced in a Long Term Service release. Advani's response was clear, Canonical is not competing with Microsoft, they are simply trying to make the best and simplest OS out there.

Ubuntu One was a service introduced with Ubuntu 9.10

and improved in 10.04. Ubuntu One is a Canonical-operated service which is comparable to DropBox and other file syncing and storage services. It allows users to synchronize files from their desktop to the Ubuntu One server, which provides 2 GB free storage — with more available for a monthly fee — and was integrated with Ubuntu 9.10. New features in the service include the ability to synchronize your local contacts from Evolution or Thunderbird and notes in Tomboy. Synchronizing with mobile phones is also available in beta for paid accounts.

This service was criticized for not having an open source server. However, the client application is open source, and so is the specification for the syncing protocol, allowing anyone to write their own server. Advani pointed out that few people would be interested in setting up their own server, and if Ubuntu One didn't suit them they could always use third party services such as DropBox. We asked what Canonical was doing to spread Linux awareness in schools so students can be exposed and used to the new environment from the start.

He told us that the Assam government recently gave 28,000 Ubuntu based computers to students. He also claimed that there were more of such ventures, but the participants would reveal the information at their own discretion.

It is heartening to learn that Indian students are being exposed to the open source culture; of all countries, perhaps we have the most to gain from this. It seems Canonical has good things planned, we can't wait till the first beta of Ubuntu 10.10! **d**



Ubuntu's Software Center

movement of seeds — will be able to securely share your private photos, videos and other data; they will also allow you to do send the same kind of updates you send right now, all securely done using encryption. You will be able to pull in and recover your data from current social networking services, and consolidate in one place which is in your control. While Diaspora

standing bugs, and focusing instead of the kind of changes no one would want.

Whatever they may say, Ubuntu is one of the few distributions which has actually managed to gain appeal as a desktop distribution, and managed to get itself preinstalled on laptops and netbooks. We had a conversation with Mr Prakash Advani, Asia Pacific Head,

